The Mountaineer
Fall 1999

ANNUAL MEETING
by
Frank Rutherford

For those of you who missed the Annual Meeting in July, it was the shortest in recent memory. The minutes of the previous Annual Meeting were approved with some minor corrections, and the operating budget for this year was approved. The budget is based on the tri-annual assessment that was approved in July of 1998.

Now that we have been operating the new water system for one year, and have a separate set of financial records, we can begin the process of filing for a reduction in our water rates. We hope to have the initial paper work done this fall. When the actual rate reduction will be approved, depends on the State of West Virginia.

The recommended changes to the covenants were discussed one more time. Also open for discussion were the revisions to the regulations regarding the use of property. This fall, members will vote on the proposed changes to these documents. In order for them to be approved, a two-thirds majority vote of the membership is necessary.

The slate of nominees was presented by Dick Lehman. Maria Barrett, Elmer Broxson, Joan Bradfield and Paul Kagen were elected. The new Board of Directors convened after the Annual Meeting to elect officers for the coming year. The officers are: President: Frank Rutherford, VP: Richard Kaufman, Secretary: Joan Bradfield, Treasurer: Paul Kagen.

The meeting was adjourned before 4:00. About eighty-five people gathered at the barn for a wonderful catered dinner and a night of socializing.

CMA TIES FOR STATE'S BEST WATER
from Morgan Messenger

Water produced by the Coolfont Mountainside Association of Morgan County finished in a first place tie with water produced by the City of Follansbee as West Virginia's best tasting water.

Those were the results of the "Water Taste Testing" competition held at the West Virginia Rural Water Association's 14th Annual Training and Technical Conference held at Canaan Valley Resort and Conference Center September 12-15. In addition to taste, water samples were also selected for clarity.

The winners were honored during the conference's annual awards banquet, where systems and personnel from 270 WVRWA member utilities are recognized each year for outstanding achievements in serving customers. Over 600 people attended this year's West Virginia Rural Water Association Conference which included 38 training sessions for water and wastewater operators and administrators.

COMMITTEE CHAIRS AND REPORTS

- **Security:** Jackson Bain

  Coolfont Resort recently hired a management company based in Williamsburg, Virginia to manage the resort. Randy English has moved from Virginia to the mountainside and will be the Operation Manager for the resort. As soon as he settles in, we will be reviewing our security arrangements with Coolfont.

- **Social/Communication**: Rosemary Bigelow

  We had a great annual meeting weekend! After the meeting, we had a cocktail party and catered dinner at the barn, attended by eighty-five people. Except for the wonderful 25th CMA Anniversary party, this is the most people we've had at a CMA social event. On Sunday morning we had three open houses; everyone enjoyed making the rounds and visiting with their CMA neighbors. Many thanks to David and Karen Bakkegard, Glenn and Helen Pearson, Sherry Rubin and Wendy Smith for sharing their homes with us. And kudos to Elmer Broxson for again arranging the barn festivities.

  Because of the holidays and uncertain weather conditions during the winter months, we have decided there will be no potlucks for the months of December, January and February.

  Thanks to increased funds in the new budget, we now have sixty chairs in the barn. John Hobday is looking into large exhaust fans to make the barn even more enjoyable in the summer.

  So long to Greta Weinberger, who has moved to Leisure World in Silver Spring, MD. Also so long to Ed and Kathy Neill who sold their house to the new management team for the resort.

DID YOU KNOW:

The Morgan County Observatory Foundation is planning to have a Sky Watch Star Party once a month. Anyone who would like to attend is welcome. Members of the Foundation set up telescopes and share their knowledge. Memberships are being sold for $20 for individual and $35 for a family. For more information contact Kevin Boles, 258-5382. Hope to see you at one of the Star Parties.

There's a new gourmet restaurant in town called "Lot 12 Public House", located on Warren Street and one block from the Senior Center. The food is described as "upscale American cuisine with a Northern Italian influence". Prices are high but reports are it's very good and has a lovely ambiance. The restaurant is open Wednesday through Sunday nights for dinner from 5PM to 10PM. Reservations are suggested, 258-6264.

This newsletter is the shortest one I've done in the past three years, and we can blame it on our daughter. She got married the end of August and I'm afraid that took precedence over the newsletter this quarter. Then while our daughter and her husband went on their honeymoon to Hawaii, Roland and I, went on our parentmoon to Alaska with our good friends, Gale and Kitty Connor. Just for a chuckle: with a name like Siushansian, who did she marry? Frank Smith!

Till next newsletter. If anyone would like to submit an article, please contact me.

Mary Ann Siushanstan

- **Recreation:** Elaine Anderson

As the 1999 summer season closed we would like to report that over 1200 visitors used the pool this summer. Our two life guards, Rebecca and Stephanie, did a conscientious job. The porta potty was appreciated by all those at the pool. Five new lounge chairs were added to the pool area. Plans for a changing room and toilet are continuing.

New charges for the after hours rental of the pool will go into effect next summer: a flat rate of $30 for the first hour will include the Jacuzzi and CMA life guard, and $10 for each additional hour contingent on the availability of a CMA lifeguard throughout the event. There is a copy of the form with this newsletter.

The tennis courts also seem to be getting heavy use. The Recreation Committee would like to take a survey of the number of users during a typical season. Next season each user will be asked to register at the court on a sign in sheet. Thank you in advance for your help.

A Barn Use Request form is also included in this newsletter. The fee to rent the Barn is $25, plus a $100 security deposit. A check for $125 payable to CMA should be included with the form and returned to John Hobday.

Anyone interested in serving on the Recreation Committee is welcome. Please contact Elaine Anderson.

- **By-laws:** Herb Jasper

The Bylaws and Covenants Committee has completed its work with the adoption of Bylaw changes by the members in 1998 and the revision of the proposed Covenants amendments, taking into account all suggestions made. Action on the latter now awaits their submission to the members by the Board and approval in writing by two-thirds of the members.

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

by

Frank Rutherford

As I start my second term as President of The Coolfont Mountainside Association, I want to thank those of you who helped me through my first year. Foremost, I thank the Siushansians who, for the past several years, have devoted many hours and weekends to the Association. Secondly, thanks goes to all the Board members who have worked diligently to solve the problems which confront the Association. And thirdly, I thank the committee chairs and members providing the behind-the-scenes support for CMA.

Last year I set forth ten goals for the Board. We have worked very hard to try and achieve these goals. Currently, only three are completed. Several others are still being worked on as we try to balance our needs with our budget. One primary focus this year will be the reduction of the water rate. Paul Kagen, Treasurer, and Elmer Broxson, Water System Chair, are working on our annual report for the PSC. The final figures from the report will serve as the basis for our file for a rate reduction.

In closing I encourage all of you to volunteer as much as you can to help CMA continue to grow as a community. Hope to see you on the Mountainside.

What's Happening At Coolfont

In light of all of the rumors that have been circulating around the mountainside, I asked Sam Ashelman if he would like to write a brief article about what is happening at the resort with regard to management. Here's what he has to say:

" At the CMA Board of Directors meeting in September, I introduced Randy English, who is our new General Manager. Randy was recommended by Newport Hospitality Group (NHG).

I mentioned that the Board of Directors of CRI had recently employed a management company, NHG, based on a recommendation of an outstanding consultant for resort companies. They have a team of experts, who are available to do specialty work such as training, supervision of our food program, quality of service in many ways, including improving efficiency. We expect that this will add quite a lot of value to CRI and therefore help make the investment in your homes at Coolfont worth more to you and others.

As a result of this, Martha and I will not be in the direct line of management. The new company will report to the Board of Directors of which I am the President, my son, Randall, is the Vice President and Treasurer, and my daughter, Siri Thar is the Secretary.

We expect to work closely with CMA. I want to concentrate my time on improving and expanding the Coolfont Foundation. I would appreciate your help."

COOLFONT FOUNDATION

The Coolfont Foundation is in the need of rental homes on the mountainside for their housing of visiting artists. There is no rental fee but you can receive a substantial tax deduction for renting your home. Call Karen Burns at Coolfont 258-4500 ext. 777 for more information.

committee reports continued

- **Water Systems Committee:** Elmer Broxson

Y2K Preparations: Upon learning that the cost of generators to supply our own power for pumping water would be at least $8,000, the Board accepted, at its August meeting, the recommendation of the Committee that all reservoirs be filled to capacity by December 30. This would give the CMA up to ten days water supply, depending on the number of houses in use. Since most CMA houses are all-electric (heating, cooking, etc), those fearful of long term power outages are unlikely to come to Coolfont.

It was recommended by the Director of the WV Office of Emergency Services, in a speech to the WV Rural Water Association Conference, that residents should prepare for January 1, 2000 as one would for an approaching snow or rain storm, for temporary power outages by having on hand candles, flashlights, kerosene lamps, a battery operated radio and some canned goods and water supplies. The power and telephone systems serving West Virginia are all "Y2K Bug Free".

EMERGENCY PHONE NUMBERS

CMA SECURITY: Loud music, speeding cars, wood theft, vandalisim, etc.
Coolfont main switchboard: **258-4500**

CRIME: Major vandalism, break-ins, robbery or other theft
Morgan County Sheriff's Office **258-1067**

FIRE OR MEDICAL EMERGENCY:
Berkeley Springs Volunteer Fire Dept. **258-9911**

TRAFFIC ACCIDENTS:
West Virginia State Police **258-2101**

BOARD MEETINGS

All meetings are at 10AM except where noted.

DATE	MEETING PLACE	POT LUCK
10/23 (9AM)	Rutherford (H-7)	Auslander/Meeker (S-3)
11/13 (9AM)	Siushansian (Q-3)	Waters (K-11)
12/11	Barrett (K-4)	None
1/15	Barrett (K-4)	None
2/12	Kaufman (R-3)	None
3/11	Bradfield (N-3)	Siushansian (Q-3)
4/15	Bradfield (N-3)	
5/13		
6/17		Barn
7/22	Treetop 9AM Annual Meeting 1 PM	Barn

If anyone has any problems with their water bills, please contact Paul Kagen at 301-946-0668.

E-MAIL CHANGES

- Davis: QueenBubbl@aol.com
- Lowenstein: jlowenstein discontinued; flowenstein is still in use
- Sophar: discontinued
- Umbel: umbel@erols.com
- Jodie & Randy English: jodie@coolfont.com

If you would like to have your e-mail included please send an e-mail to Marie Barret: (MRBarrett@worldnet.att.net).

NEW CMA MEMBERS

Please add the following new members to the mountainside:

Susan Tuft, (D-1), 14 Coolfont, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411 - 258-6805
Randy and Jodie English, (Q-9), P.O. Box 923, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411
258-7890

Houses and Lots for Sale in Coolfont

Please let Mary Ann Siushansian know if your lot or house has been sold, put on the market, or price changed for the next newsletter.
Some of these lots and houses are for sale by Sam Ashelman's company, some by Kesecker Realty in Berkeley Springs, and some by the owners.

LOTS:

Lot A-2: $29,000
Lot E-3: $34,500
Lot H-1: $41,500
Lot H-5: $33,000
Lot K-1 & K-2: $78,000 (K-1: $42,500, K-2: $38,000)
Lot K-12: $36,900
Lot K-14: $45,000
Lot L-6: $35,000
Lot Q-7: $37,000
Lot S-6: $68,950

HOUSES:

House K-5 Bear's Den: $229,500
House P-5 Dream Time: $119,900